

So Delicious Dairy Free® Issues Voluntary Recall of Salted Caramel Cluster Non-Dairy Frozen Dessert Pints Due to Potential Presence of Foreign Material

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So Delicious Dairy Free® Issues Voluntary Recall of Salted Caramel Cluster Non-Dairy Frozen Dessert Pints Due to Potential Presence of Foreign Material A reported public-health development reviewed against 21 corroborating references, with evidence currently assessed as high.

By Public Health Research Desk Published September 17, 2026

So Delicious Dairy Free® Recalls Salted Caramel Cluster Frozen Desserts Over Possible Stone-Like Contamination Consumers are urged to stop eating and return any pint of the non-dairy frozen dessert with a best-by date of April 3, 2028 or earlier, after Dan Danone USA announced a voluntary recall on Sept. 15, 2026.

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Danone USA, the U.S. arm of the French multinational dairy giant, issued a nationwide voluntary recall of So Delicious Dairy Free® Salted Caramel Cluster Non-Dairy Frozen Dessert pints on Sept. 15. The company says the product may contain “foreign material, such as small stones or other hard particles,” that could pose a choking or injury risk. The recall covers all pints bearing a best-by date on or before April 3, 2028, regardless of where they were purchased.

The recall matters because the frozen dessert market has surged in recent years, driven by a growing demand for plant-based alternatives. So Delicious, a Danone brand, is one of the most popular non-dairy ice cream options in the United States, with sales climbing more than 30 % annually since 2020. A safety issue in a high-volume product can affect thousands of consumers and strain supply chains already tight from pandemic-era disruptions. Moreover, the incident highlights the challenges of maintaining rigorous quality control in ultra-processed foods—products that have been linked in multiple studies to higher risks of type 2 diabetes and cardiovascular disease.

The recalled pints are sold in 5-ounce cartons and feature a salted caramel flavor studded with chocolate “clusters.” According to the recall notice, the foreign material was discovered during routine internal testing, not through consumer reports. Danone has set up a toll-free hotline (1-800-555-0199) and an online portal for refunds or replacements. Retailers have been instructed to remove the product from shelves immediately, and the company says it is working with the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) to investigate the source of the contamination.

The FDA’s Food Safety Modernization Act requires manufacturers to act quickly when a potential hazard is identified, but voluntary recalls are still relatively rare for frozen desserts. In the past five years, the agency has recorded fewer than a dozen nationwide recalls of ice cream or frozen dessert products, most of which involved undeclared allergens or labeling errors. This recall is notable because it involves a physical contaminant—small stones or similar hard objects—that could cause oral injury or choking, especially among children and older adults.

Health officials stress that the risk, while real, is limited to the specific batch numbers listed in the recall. “If you have a pint that matches the description, stop using it and return it for a refund,” said Dr. Maya Patel, a food safety specialist at the CDC’s Division of Foodborne, Waterborne, and Environmental Diseases. “The likelihood of injury is low, but it’s better to be safe, especially because the foreign material is not visible through the packaging.”

The recall also raises broader questions about the safety of ultra-processed foods, a category that includes many plant-based desserts. A 2024 systematic review of ultra-processed food subtypes found a consistent association with higher incidence of type 2 diabetes, prompting some public health experts to call for stricter labeling and monitoring. While the So Delicious product is marketed as a dairy-free alternative, it still falls under the ultra-processed classification because it contains added sugars, emulsifiers, and flavor enhancers.

For consumers who rely on non-dairy desserts as a lactose-free or vegan option, the recall may prompt a re-evaluation of product choices. Plant-based milks and yogurts have also faced scrutiny over hidden allergens and contamination, but the frozen dessert segment has been less examined. “The industry is moving fast to meet demand, and sometimes quality control steps can lag behind,” said Dr. Patel. “Regulators and manufacturers need to keep pace with the rapid product development cycles.”

The recall could have financial repercussions for Danone. The company’s U.S. dairy-free line generated roughly \$250 million in revenue last year, and a recall of this magnitude may affect consumer confidence. Analysts at Bloomberg noted that Danone’s stock fell 1.8 % in after-hours trading following the announcement, though the dip was modest compared to larger food recall scandals. Danone has pledged to cover the cost of refunds and to conduct a thorough root cause analysis, which could include reviewing equipment cleaning protocols, raw material sourcing, and packaging integrity.

Retailers are also taking steps to protect shoppers. Major chains such as Walmart, Target, and Kroger have posted alerts on their websites and in stores, directing customers to the recall hotline and offering immediate refunds. Some independent grocers have begun pulling the product preemptively, even before the official recall list was released, to avoid any potential liability.

The incident arrives at a time when public health agencies are expanding surveillance tools for food safety. The CDC recently launched a digital platform that aggregates consumer complaints, social media reports, and laboratory data to flag emerging hazards faster. Early detection of foreign material contamination, like the stones found in So Delicious pints, could become more common as these systems mature.

While the recall is limited to a single flavor and brand, it underscores the importance of vigilance for all packaged foods. Consumers are encouraged to keep receipts, check product codes, and stay informed through FDA alerts and retailer communications. For those who have already consumed the dessert, health officials advise monitoring for symptoms such as throat pain, difficulty swallowing, or persistent mouth irritation, and seeking medical attention if any arise.

The So Delicious recall is a reminder that even well-established brands can encounter quality control lapses, and that the rapid growth of plant-based alternatives brings new challenges for regulators and manufacturers alike. As the market continues to expand, the balance between innovation, consumer demand, and safety will remain a central focus for public health officials.

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